

Unit: Surveillance: The Giver

詳細內容雙語對照 / Detailed Bilingual Content

Unit Introduction / 單元導言

In this unit, we are going to learn about the second type of learning material that I recommend to learners frequently, which is the young adult novel. Then, we will look at a world-famous awarded young adult novel "The Giver", followed by a short briefing on some utopian literary works.

在本單元中，我們將學習我經常向學習者推薦的第二種學習材料，即青少年小說 (young adult novel)。然後，我們將看看一部世界著名的獲獎青少年小說《記憶傳授人》(The Giver)，隨後對一些烏托邦文學作品進行簡要介紹。

Lead-in Dialogue / 導入對話

Jack: Did you watch the news today? So many crimes everywhere... It's like everyone has gone mad! What a horrible world we all live in! Sam: Don't you love the world now? What's your ideal world like? Jack: I want a world that people feel safe, where there is no war, and all men are equal without racism. Sam: A utopia, you mean. Jack: That would be nice, wouldn't it? Sam: Can't agree more!

傑克：你今天看新聞了嗎？到處都有那麼多犯罪.....簡直每個人都瘋了！我們生活的世界真是太可怕了！

山姆：你現在不愛這個世界了嗎？你理想中的世界是什麼樣的？

傑克：我想要一個讓人們感到安全、沒有戰爭、人人平等且沒有種族主義的世界。山姆：你的意思是，一個烏托邦。

傑克：那會很美好，不是嗎？山姆：再同意不過了！

Utopia & Dystopia / 烏托邦與反烏托邦

Definition of Utopia (from Cambridge Online Dictionary): The idea of a perfect society in which everyone works well with each other and is happy.

烏托邦的定義 (來自劍橋線上詞典)：一個每個人都與其他人相處融洽且幸福的完美社會的構想 (烏托邦；理想中的完美世界)。

From the above definition, we know that there is not a utopia yet, even though some Scandinavian nations were ranked at the top in the World Happiness Report, they are not perfect or ideal. So far, utopia is only "an imaginary (non-existent) community or society that possesses highly desirable or nearly perfect qualities for its members." The word was coined by Sir Thomas More in his work Utopia in 1516. The word utopia was composed of the οὐ ("not") and τόπος ("place") in Greek, and it meant any non-existent society in More's original work. There is a word with similar spelling and meaning, which is eutopia, meaning "good place", from Greek: εὖ ("good" or "well") and τόπος ("place"). The pronunciation of 'utopia' and 'eutopia' are identical, but the difference in meaning is subtle because eutopia would fit the modern idea of utopia better than utopia.

從上述定義中，我們知道目前還沒有烏托邦，儘管一些斯堪地那維亞國家在《世界幸福報告》中名列前茅，但它們並不完美或理想。到目前為止，烏托邦僅僅是「一個虛構的（不存在的）社區或社會，為其成員擁有高度令人嚮往或近乎完美的品質。」這個詞是托馬斯·摩爾爵士在1516年的著作《烏托邦》中創造的。烏托邦一詞由希臘語中的 οὐ (「不」) 和 τόπος (「地方」) 組成，在摩爾的原著中意為任何不存在的社會。有一個拼寫和含義相似的詞，即 eutopia，意為「美好的地方」，來自希臘語中的 εὖ (「好」或「好地」) 和 τόπος (「地方」)。「utopia」and「eutopia」的發音是相同的，但含義上的差別很微妙，因為 eutopia 比 utopia 更符合現代的烏托邦觀點。

Would you like to live in a society where every meal is delivered to your door, a job assigned to you based on your observed specialty, with no climate change while everyone is polite and respectful? This sounds a little like utopia, doesn't it? Maybe someday this will happen, but so far, we have only reached the first one 'meal delivery to the doorstep' after the Covid pandemic. Nevertheless, utopian societies exist in many books. The world I have described in the beginning of this paragraph can be found in the novel 'The Giver' by Lois Lowry.

你想生活在一個每頓飯都送到你門口，根據你所觀察到的特長為你分配工作，沒有氣候變化，而且每個人都禮貌和尊重他人的社會中嗎？這聽起來有點像烏托邦，不是嗎？也許有一天這會實現，但到目前為止，在新冠疫情大流行之後，我們只實現了第一個「送餐上門」。然而，烏托邦社會存在於許多書中。我所描述的世界可以在洛伊絲·洛利 (Lois Lowry) 的小說《記憶傳授人》(The Giver) 中找到。

The Giver by Lois Lowry / 《記憶傳授人》介紹

The Giver was written as young adult novel, as the target readers are 12- to 18-year-old teenagers. Novels are different from stories for they include more details so the readers can contemplate on why, relate to the characters, emphasize, and find causal relationships. Young adult novels differ from novels for they have clear central themes, which is good for language learning. From these themes, we can easily expand vocabulary from the theme and put them into listening, writing or speaking exercises immediately. The second advantage of using young adult novel for English learning is that they tend to be shorter than novels written for adults. Also, classic or awarded young adult novels are often adopted into movies, which we can enjoy after we read for review. 'The Giver' has a movie version too.

《記憶傳授人》是作為青少年小說撰寫的，因為目標讀者是 12 至 18 歲的青少年。小說不同於短篇故事，因為它們包含更多細節，使讀者能夠思考原因、與角色產生共鳴、產生同理心並尋找因果關係。青少年小說不同於普通小說，因為它們有明確的中心主題，這對語言學習很有好處。從這些主題中，我們可以輕鬆地擴展主題詞彙，並立即將其放入聽力、寫作或口說練習中。使用青少年小說學習英語的第二個好處是，它們往往比為成年人寫的小說要短。此外，經典或獲獎的青少年小說經常被改編成電影，我們可以在閱讀後觀看以進行複習。《記憶傳授人》也有電影版本。

From the summary of the back cover of the book, we see the main character 'Jonas' lives in a perfect world, a utopia. In Jonas' world, everything is arranged, decided and regulated though; the citizens of the 'community' are carefully monitored (watched) by the 'Committee of Elders' and everyone must obey the rules, or they will be warned and punished. Language must be precise, for instance, the concept of 'love' becomes too abstract and vague, so the word 'love' is banned. Everything you say or do is watched 24/7. Would you like to live in a world like this?

從書的封底簡介中，我們看到主角「喬納斯」生活在一個完美的世界，一個烏托邦。然而，在喬納斯的世界裡，一切都是被安排、決定和監管的；「長老委員會」仔細監控（觀看）「社區」的公民，每個人都必須遵守規則，否則他們將受到警告和懲罰。語言必須精確，例如，「愛」的概念變得太抽象和模糊，所以「愛」這個詞被禁止了。你說的或做的每一件事都受到24小時全天候的監控。你想生活在這樣的世界裡嗎？

Surveillance Society / 監視社會

Definition of Surveillance (from Cambridge Online Dictionary): The careful watching of a person or place, especially by the police or army, because of a crime that has happened or is expected.

監視 (Surveillance) 的定義：對某人或某個地方的仔細觀察，特別是由警察或軍隊進行，因為發生了或預期會發生犯罪。

You might not be aware, but our society nowadays is a surveillance society. Have you thought about how many times you were on camera each day? I can give you some hints. Think about the cameras on the streets, at the crossroads, at the entrances and exits of buildings, dash cams on cars passing you on the roads, on the ATMs while you withdrawing cash, cameras installed by grocery shops, not to mention the accidental shot of someone taking a selfie next to you. We now leave our digital prints everywhere, online shopping, credit card purchase, cell phone records and details, financial investments, leisure music data and so on. We can be under surveillance from our whereabouts, financial dealings to our personal lifestyle choices very easily.

你可能沒有意識到，但我們如今的社會是一個監視社會。你是否想過你每天有多少次出現在鏡頭前？我可以給你一些提示。想想街上的攝像頭、十字路口、建築物的出入口、道路上擦身而過的車輛上的行車記錄器、取款時自動取款機上的攝像頭、雜貨店安裝的攝像頭，更不用說有人在你身旁自拍時意外拍到你的畫面。我們現在到處都留下數位足跡：線上購物、信用卡消費、手機記錄和詳細信息、金融投資、休閒音樂數據等。我們可以非常容易地在行蹤、財務往來以及個人生活方式選擇方面受到監視。

Some people do not mind being watched because they think surveillance can deter crimes and they have nothing to hide; however, others might feel uncomfortable being watched as too much security threatens people's freedom. With the advancement of biometric facial recognition, police can find a person very easily, possibly within hours or minutes. So, let us think about it for a while. Are you willing to exchange your freedom for security? Of course, this is up to you. However, in most of the utopian novels, the main characters are usually anti-utopian; they choose to fight against the perfect system to maintain more humanity. For instance, Jonas in *The Giver* left the community. So, a perfect world is not everyone's choice. I will not spoil your fun of reading, but one thing I can tell you is that *The Giver* has three sequels, *Gathering Blue*, *Messenger*, and *Son*.

有些人不介意被監視，因為他們認為監視可以威懾犯罪，而且他們沒有什麼可隱隱瞞的；然而，其他人可能會因為被監視而感到不舒服，因為過多的安全威脅到了人們的自由。隨著生物識別面部識別技術的進步，警方可以非常容易地找到一個人，可能在幾小時或幾分鐘內。所以，讓我們思考一下。你願意用自由換取安全嗎？當然，這取決於你。然而，在大多數烏托邦小說中，主角通常是反烏托邦的；他們選擇與完美的系統抗爭以維護更多的人性。例如，《記憶傳授人》中的喬納斯離開了社區。所以，一個完美的世界並不是每個人的選擇。我不會劇透你的閱讀樂趣，但有一件事我可以告訴你，《記憶傳授人》有三部續集：《藍色尋覓》（*Gathering Blue*）、《森林信使》（*Messenger*）和《兒子》（*Son*）。

In a lot of the utopian novels, the storyline is actually dystopian, meaning 'bad place', which is the opposite of a utopia. Somehow a superficial perfect world turns into a cruel world because of the surveillance and centralization of power leading to social hierarchy, sameness and loss of freewill and choice. Another masterpiece, even more famous than *The Giver*, is George Orwell's science fiction novel *1984*, which was published in 1949. The story took place in 1984, which was a future for Orwell when he wrote the novel. The story was deep and insightful, but long, really long. Many terms that we are familiar with originate from *1984*, such as "The Big Brother Is Watching You", "doublethink", "Thought Police", "thoughtcrime", "Newspeak", and "2+2=5". Together with Orwell's *1984*, Huxley's *Brave New World* and Zamyatin's *We* are called Dystopian trilogy. Since *1984* is a serious classic and masterpiece, the language is not easy to read. You might want to start with the Chinese translated book to know the story first. An international reality television franchise *Big Brother* uses allusion from *1984*.

在許多烏托邦小說中，情節實際上是反烏托邦（*dystopian*）的，意為「糟糕的地方」，這是烏托邦的反義詞。由於監視和權力集中導致社會階級、千篇一律以及失去自由意志和選擇，表面上完美的世界不知何故變成了殘酷的世界。另一部比《記憶傳授人》更著名的傑作是喬治·歐威爾於1949年出版的科幻小說《1984》。故事發生在1984年，這對歐威爾寫作該小說時來說是未來。這個故事深刻而富有洞察力，但很長，真的很長。許多我們熟悉的術語都源自《1984》，例如「老大哥在看著你」、「雙重思想」、「思想警察」、「思想犯罪」、「新話」和「2+2=5」。與歐威爾的《1984》、赫胥黎的《美麗新世界》和扎米亞京的《我們》並稱為反烏托邦三部曲。由於《1984》是一部嚴肅的經典和傑作，其語言不易閱讀。您可能想先從中文譯本開始以了解故事。

Related Utopian/Dystopian Works / 相關烏托邦/反烏托邦作品

Graded reader: Cambridge English Reader "In the House" (level 4)

分級讀物：劍橋英語讀物《屋子裡》（第四級）

Novel: *Fahrenheit 451* by Ray Bradbury

小說：雷·布萊伯利的《華氏451度》

Film 1: *The Truman Show* (1998)

電影 1：《楚門的世界》（1998年）

Film 2: *Minority Report* (2002)

電影 2 : 《關鍵報告》 (2002年)

Film 3: The Island (2005)

電影 3 : 《絕地再生》 (2005年)

Film 4: The Hunger Games (2012)

電影 4 : 《飢餓遊戲》 (2012年)

TV Series: The Handmaid' s Tale (2017)

電視劇 : 《使女的故事》 (2017年)

Other Languages: "Folding Beijing" by Hao Jingfang

其他語言 : 郝景芳的《北京折疊》 (雨果獎得獎作品)